Volkswagen Beetle, Kombi & Country Buggy (Australia) Specification & Service Referenc

AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Volkswagen | Model: Beetle, Kombi & Country Buggy | Australian Market Years: 1954-1979
Vehicle Type: Sedan / Convertible / Microbus / Van / Ute / Off-Roader | Segment: Classic Compact / Light
Assembly Plants (AU): Clayton, Victoria (1954-1976)

1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The bedrock of Volkswagen’s Australian history. Starting with CKD assembly in Melbourne in 1954 , the Type 1 Beetle and Type 2 Kombi progressed to full local manufacture at Clayton, Victoria, achieving over 80% Australian domestic content. Clayton also designed and manufactured the uni que Australian Volkswagen Country Buggy (Type 197).

First assembled at Martin & King in Clayton in 1954 before Volkswagen Australasia purchased the plant. The Beetle became Australia’s top-selling small car through the 1960s, while the Kombi became an indelible part of Australian surf culture, commercial trades, and camper touring. Cla yton produced 1,956 Australian-exclusive Country Buggies in 1968.

SERIES / GENERATION: Type 1 (Beetle Type 1 (Sedan & Super Beetle)) [1954-1976]

Body Styles: 2-door sedan, 2-door cabriolet | ANCAP: Unrated (Pre-ANCAP)
Clayton-assembled air-cooled rear-engine legend. Progressed from 1192cc 1200 through 1285cc 130 0, 1493cc 1500, to 1584cc 1600 Super Beetle (1302S and 1303S) with MacPherson strut front suspe nsion.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- 1200: 1.2L (1192cc) Flat-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 25 kW / 82 Nm
- 1300: 1.3L (1285cc) Flat-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 29 kW / 87 Nm
- 1500: 1.5L (1493cc) Flat-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 33 kW / 106 Nm
- 1600: 1.6L (1584cc) Flat-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 37 kW / 106 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Standard 1200: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual, AUD $1798-$2040, Fuel=7.5L/100km
- Deluxe 1300: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual, AUD $1990-$2250, Fuel=7.8L/100km
- Super Beetle 1302S / 1303S: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual, 3-speed Semi-Automatic, AUD $2565-$

Factory Configurations:

* Standard 1200 | 2-door sedan | 1200 | 4-speed manual | RWD | 25kW/82Nm
* Super Beetle 1302S / 1303S | 2-door sedan | 1600 | 4-speed manual | RWD | 37kW/106Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: Type 197 (Country Buggy (Type 197)) [1968-1969]

Body Styles: 2-door open utility / roadster | ANCAP: Unrated (Pre-ANCAP)
Designed, engineered and manufactured exclusively in Australia by Volkswagen Australasia at Cla yton, Victoria under project director Rudi Herz. Built using Beetle floorpans, Transporter redu ction-gear portal hubs, and folded sheet-metal bodywork for extreme ground clearance in the Aus tralian outback.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- 1300: 1.3L (1285cc) Flat-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 29 kW / 87 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Country Buggy: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual with reduction hubs, AUD $1598-$1820, Fuel=8.9L/1

Factory Configurations:

* Country Buggy | 2-door open utility / roadster | 1300 | 4-speed manual with reduction hubs | RWD | 29

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SERIES / GENERATION: Type 2 (Kombi / Microbus / Transporter (Type 2 T1 & T2)) [1954-1979]

Body Styles: Van, Microbus, Dual-cab ute, Single-cab ute, Campmobile | ANCAP: Unrated (Pre-ANCAP)

The beloved Australian Kombi across Split-screen (T1) and Bay-window (T2) generations. Clayton-assembled with local interior camper fit-outs, dual-cab work utes, and delivery vans.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- 1600-T2: 1.6L (1584cc) Flat-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 37 kW / 106 Nm
- 2.0-Type4: 2.0L (1970cc) Flat-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 52 kW / 143 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Transporter Van / Ute: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual, AUD $2150-$4200, Fuel=10.5L/100km
- Microbus Deluxe & Campmobile: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual, 3-speed automatic, AUD $2690-$599

Factory Configurations:

* Microbus Deluxe & Campmobile | Campmobile | 2.0-Type4 | 4-speed manual | RWD | 52kW/143Nm